

Consultation response checklist

Prepared by Yann Stoneman, a Kew Riverside parent seeking to keep the school open. Research checked 23 September 2026; deadline and government guidance rechecked 26 September 2026. This is not an official consultation form or legal advice.

Before submitting

- ☐ Respond by 16 October 2026, the date on the council-linked form when checked on 26 September. No closing time is stated; check for updates.
- ☐ This is pre-statutory consultation. A later statutory notice would have a separate representation period.
- ☐ Read the council's proposal and supporting evidence. Choose the questions that matter to you; personal experience matters too.
- ☐ State the outcome you seek: retention of the current school, teaching on the site, or another specific arrangement.
- ☐ Respond on time even if requested records are outstanding. Keep a copy and seek an acknowledgement.

Build a concise case

- ☐ **1. The budget bridge**
The council recorded a £231,685.09 revenue reserve at 31 March 2026, then forecast exhaustion by March 2027 and a deficit above £400,000 by 2028/29. Ask for each year's income, spending, balance and pupil assumptions. [Budget explanation](#).
- ☐ **2. A deliverable alternative**
Which costed arrangements could retain education at Kew? Ask about the delivery body, premises, three-year budget and reasons for rejecting each option. A possible legal route alone is not a viable plan. [Alternatives](#).
- ☐ **3. Net closure costs**
Ask which PFI and other costs stop, continue or arise because of closure, including transition, receiving-school support and travel. Compare annual net costs, not the school deficit alone. [Closure costs](#).
- ☐ **4. Local pupil demand**
Ask which cohort and housing assumptions changed between forecast versions, and what is forecast after 2031/32. A key test in government guidance is whether the need for places is forecast to rise over the medium to long term ([Closing maintained schools, May 2026, page 8](#)). Compare forecasts with actuals for the same year and area; the earlier 2025/26 planning-area total was close to actual. [Forecast check](#).
- ☐ **5. Continuity and equality**
Ask for staffed places by year group, the Kew-specific equality assessment, SEND support, safe journeys, effects on disadvantaged pupils and funded transition arrangements. Decision-makers should consider travel, extra car use and the quality of alternative places, balanced against the need to reduce surplus places ([same guidance, pages 21-22](#)). Use anonymised public examples; share a child's individual needs privately through official services. [School-place answers](#).
- ☐ **6. Learning**
Ask what each option would preserve or change about teaching, relationships, curriculum and support. Current results and inspection describe existing provision, not the effects of a future option. [Learning evidence](#).

Write and submit your response

Suggested response structure

- ☐ My connection to the school or area.
- ☐ My requested outcome.
- ☐ My strongest evidence, with document titles, dates and page references.
- ☐ A viable alternative or a precise request for further appraisal.
- ☐ Specific pupil or community impacts, with evidence. A statutory proposal must address community impact ([same guidance, page 28](#)).
- ☐ Questions that remain unanswered.
- ☐ A request for acknowledgement and a response to the substantive points.

Official starting points

Check the official response form for the latest deadline and any updates before submitting.

Richmond Council

https://www.richmond.gov.uk/services/children_and_family_care/schools_and_colleges/school_organisation_consultations/kew_river_side_consultation

Official response form

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSda5oPsdUlrJkf6vACC_AjvXFR6-ki3iBymNIF5BAWNxf85xQ/viewform

Other participation routes

Check meeting arrangements before registering a speaker or submitting a written question:

https://www.richmond.gov.uk/council/have_your_say/participating_in_council_meetings

Check petition eligibility and handling rules:

https://www.richmond.gov.uk/council/have_your_say/petitions

A petition does not replace a formal consultation response or establish a veto.

Keep your source details

Record each source's publisher, exact title, date, public URL and relevant page or paragraph. Label forecasts, claims by a publisher and your own analysis separately. Avoid sharing identifiable information about children.

This is a research snapshot, checked 23 September 2026. Check current official material before acting.